



LIONS LIGHT ACADEMY

When You Can't Be There

Teacher absence and cover

"It is the glory of God to conceal a matter, but the glory of kings is to search it out."

PROVERBS 25:2

EFFECTIVE

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DOCUMENT

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You will miss a Tuesday. Everyone does. This page exists so that when it happens, nobody is scrambling at 8:40.

The one thing that can't bend

Every adult supervising students has completed a background check. No exceptions, and no one begins serving while a check is pending.

That is why cover is arranged rather than improvised. A willing parent standing in the hallway is not a substitute, however helpful they are, and asking them to "just watch the room for a bit" puts them and us in a position neither of us should be in.

It also means the answer is never *"someone will figure it out."* Someone specific figures it out, and this page says who.

Tell us as early as you know

Planned — an appointment, travel, a wedding: tell Damian or Ginny as soon as it lands on your calendar. Weeks ahead is normal and welcome.

Sick — Monday night or Tuesday morning: **text Damian or Ginny directly.** Not email, not the group chat. Those get read when someone next picks up a phone, and Tuesday morning is exactly when nobody is picking up a phone.

Don't wait to see whether you feel better. **An hour's notice is worth more than certainty.** If you rally, we'll happily un-arrange it.

When you message, say three things:

- Which classes and which rooms
 - Whether your own children are still coming
 - Whether you can get a lesson to us
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Send your lesson, however rough

Three lines is enough. *"Finish the reading from last week, pages 40–52, then the six questions at the end. Answers in Classroom."*

Post it in Google Classroom yourself if you can — it takes a minute from a phone, even from a waiting room.

A cover teacher with a rough plan runs a real class. A cover teacher with nothing runs a study hall, and the students know the difference.

Who covers, in order

1. **The other teacher in that age track.** They already know the students and the room.
2. **Any teacher whose block is free that period.** Most people have one.
3. **Leadership** — Damian or Ginny.
4. **Combine with another room in the same age group**, as long as it stays inside our supervision targets: Elementary 1 adult per 8–10, Middle School 1 per 10–12, High School 1 per 12–15.
5. **If none of that works, the class doesn't run that week.** We say so plainly and use the block for reading or study, supervised. We do not park students somewhere and call it covered.

Leadership arranges this. You do not need to find your own replacement — tell us, and then go be unwell.

Nobody falls behind for a week you weren't there

Our Escalation & Discipline Policy counts required work not completed for **two class sessions in a row** as a Moderate concern.

A session you missed is not one of those sessions. If work never went up because you were out, it does not count against a student, and no warning follows from it. Tell leadership what didn't post and it's noted.

Cancelling the whole day is a different thing

One teacher out is cover. The whole day is a cancellation, and that is leadership's call, not yours.

If the Winslow public school district cancels, LLA cancels. Families are told by phone, text, and the co-op's chat spaces as early as we can manage.

If you're going to be out repeatedly

Tell us. A hard season, a new baby, a job that changed shape — say it out loud rather than managing it one Tuesday at a time.

We would far rather rework the schedule around a teacher we want to keep than lose them to a term of quiet guilt.

Questions, or to tell us you'll be out: **text Damian or Ginny.**